

Geometry Studio

Computer Graphics 3D Project Report

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Abstract

Geometry Studio is an interactive WebGL2 application for demonstrating core computer graphics concepts in three-dimensional space. The project implements primitive geometry generation, model loading, solid/point/line rendering modes, perspective projection controls, affine transformations, lighting, shadows, texture mapping, animation, scene persistence, and an evaluator-focused tour. The application is built with Three.js, TypeScript, and Vite, and is packaged as a static release that can be served locally for grading.

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1 Project Overview

The goal of this project is to build a practical 3D graphics studio rather than a collection of isolated demonstrations. The application allows users to create objects, inspect their rendering modes, transform them interactively, adjust the camera projection, configure lights and shadows, apply textures, import external models, and run animations.

The project is designed for two audiences:

- **Course evaluators**, who need to verify that every assignment requirement is implemented clearly.
- **Students and developers**, who need a maintainable source structure that demonstrates how a real-time graphics application is organized.

2 Technology Stack

Technology	Purpose
Three.js 0.184.0	WebGL2 rendering, geometry, materials, lighting, shadows, controls, loaders, and post-processing.
TypeScript 6.0.3	Static typing and safer long-term source maintenance.
Vite 8.0.14	Development server and static production build.
Lucide	UI icon system.
Playwright	Browser smoke tests for release validation.
pdflatex	English report generation from LaTeX source.

Table 1: Main technologies used in the project.

3 Implemented Requirements

3.1 3D Geometry

The application supports the required primitive shapes:

- Box / Cube
- Sphere
- Cone
- Cylinder
- Wheel / Torus
- Teapot

Additional self-researched shapes are also included:

- Torus Knot
- Tube Curve
- Tetrahedron, Octahedron, Dodecahedron, and Icosahedron

- Parametric Surface
- Extruded Star
- Built-in sample drone model for model-loading demonstrations

Primitive geometry is generated using Three.js buffer geometries and normalized so that objects are centered in the scene and placed naturally on the ground plane. This makes the scene easier to inspect and makes object transformations more predictable.

3.2 Rendering Modes

Each object can be displayed in three required modes:

- **Solid:** rendered as a mesh with material and lighting.
- **Points:** rendered as vertices using `THREE.Points`.
- **Lines:** rendered using `WireframeGeometry` and `LineSegments`.

The line mode deliberately uses a real wireframe geometry instead of a single `Line` object. This avoids incomplete edge rendering on complex geometry and imported models.

3.3 Perspective Projection

The project uses `THREE.PerspectiveCamera`. The user can adjust:

- Camera position on the X, Y, and Z axes
- Field of view
- Near clipping plane
- Far clipping plane

Camera presets are provided for front, top, isometric, and reset views. A camera frustum helper can be enabled to make the projection volume visible during evaluation.

3.4 Affine Transformations

Affine transformations are implemented with `TransformControls`. The selected object can be translated, rotated, or scaled using:

- On-screen transform gizmos
- Keyboard shortcuts: T, R, and S
- Numeric inspector fields for X, Y, and Z values
- World-space and local-space transform modes

Each scene object is wrapped in a `THREE.Group`, which provides a stable transform root even when the object's internal visual representation changes between solid, point, and line modes.

3.5 Lighting and Shadows

The lighting system includes:

- Ambient light for global illumination
- Directional light to simulate sunlight
- Point light
- Spot light

The user can control light color, intensity, position, helpers, shadow state, and a light sweep animation. The renderer uses `PCFSoftShadowMap` and a shadow-receiving ground plane to make shadows visible during grading.

3.6 Texture Mapping

The project includes built-in procedural texture presets:

- Checker
- UV grid
- Grid

Users can also upload bitmap images from their computer. Uploaded textures are loaded through `TextureLoader`, assigned to the selected material, and configured with sRGB color space. Repeat values on the X and Y axes can be adjusted from the inspector.

3.7 Model Loading

The application supports external model import in the following formats:

- GLB / GLTF
- OBJ
- STL

The import pipeline uses `LoadingManager` for progress reporting and clear error messages. Imported objects are normalized, centered, scaled to a reasonable size, placed on the ground plane, and added to the same outliner and transformation workflow as primitive objects. Drag-and-drop import is also supported.

3.8 Animation

The timeline supports play and pause. Per-object animation modes include:

- Spin
- Orbit
- Bounce
- Pulse

The project also includes a light sweep animation. Animation updates use elapsed time and frame delta values so that motion remains stable across displays with different refresh rates.

4 Advanced Features

4.1 Scene Persistence

The application can save and load a typed JSON scene document. The document stores:

- Scene version and save time
- Object names, types, render modes, materials, colors, textures, and transforms
- Object animation settings
- Camera position, target, field of view, near plane, and far plane
- Display settings such as grid, axes, stats, and frustum helper
- Lighting configuration

External model binary data is not embedded into the JSON document. If a saved scene references an imported model, the loader restores a built-in sample placeholder so the scene workflow remains usable.

4.2 Undo and Redo

Undo and redo are implemented through a command-history system that stores snapshots of the scene document. This allows the project to restore prior states after changes such as object creation, deletion, material changes, render mode changes, camera changes, and lighting changes.

4.3 Evaluation Tour

The Evaluation Tour is designed specifically for grading. It creates a scene that demonstrates:

- Required primitive geometry
- Solid, point, and line rendering
- Perspective camera and frustum helper
- Affine transform workflow
- Ambient, spot, and shadowed lighting
- Texture mapping
- Model-loading workflow through the built-in sample model
- Multiple animation types

Toast messages appear in sequence to explain which requirement is being shown.

4.4 Cinematic Demo and Screenshot Export

The Cinematic Demo creates a visually stronger scene with different geometry, materials, render modes, textures, and animations. The screenshot button exports the current WebGL canvas as a PNG image.

4.5 Telemetry

The telemetry panel displays FPS, draw calls, triangles, lines, points, geometry count, texture count, and object count. These values are based on `renderer.info` and help demonstrate rendering cost during manual evaluation.

5 Source Architecture

The upgraded source code is split into focused modules:

Module	Responsibility
<code>editor/types.ts</code>	Shared application types such as <code>SceneEntry</code> , <code>LightRig</code> , and <code>SceneDocument</code> .
<code>editor/documents.ts</code>	Scene JSON serialization and validation.
<code>editor/commands.ts</code>	Undo/redo snapshot history.
<code>scene/primitives.ts</code>	Primitive geometry, extra shapes, labels, and built-in sample model.
<code>scene/materials.ts</code>	Materials, texture presets, and solid/point/line visual construction.
<code>scene/lights.ts</code>	Stage, light rig, shadows, helpers, and light sweep.
<code>scene/importers.ts</code>	GLB, GLTF, OBJ, and STL import pipeline.
<code>renderer/pipeline.ts</code>	<code>WebGLRenderer</code> , <code>EffectComposer</code> , <code>OutlinePass</code> , and resize handling.
<code>animation/timeline.ts</code>	Animation update logic.
<code>ui/template.ts</code>	DOM template for the editor UI.
<code>utils/resourceTracker.ts</code>	Explicit disposal of geometries, materials, textures, and URLs.

Table 2: High-level source structure.

6 Rendering and Performance Considerations

The renderer is configured for WebGL2 with ACES tone mapping, sRGB output color space, soft shadows, and post-processing outline selection. Resize handling uses the canvas client size and caps the drawing buffer pixel count to avoid excessive GPU load on high-DPI displays.

The project explicitly disposes geometries, materials, textures, and object URLs when objects are rebuilt or removed. This follows standard Three.js resource management practices and reduces the risk of memory leaks during long editing sessions.

7 Testing

The project includes automated browser tests with Playwright:

- Startup rendering and non-empty canvas verification
- Toolbar and inspector visibility

- Object creation
- Render mode switching
- Responsive mobile layout smoke test
- Undo and redo
- Scene JSON loading
- Evaluation Tour activation

The main verification commands are:

```
npm run typecheck
npm run build
npm run test:smoke
```

8 How to Run

To run from source:

```
cd Geometry_Studio/Source
npm install
npm run dev
```

To run the static release:

```
cd Geometry_Studio/Release
python3 -m http.server 8080
```

Then open:

```
http://localhost:8080
```

9 Conclusion

Geometry Studio satisfies the project requirements for 3D geometry, rendering modes, perspective projection, affine transformations, lighting, shadows, texture mapping, model loading, and animation. The upgraded version also adds scene persistence, undo/redo, import progress, drag-and-drop, telemetry, an Evaluation Tour, screenshot export, and a modular source architecture. These features make the project easier to evaluate, easier to maintain, and more impressive as a complete computer graphics demonstration.